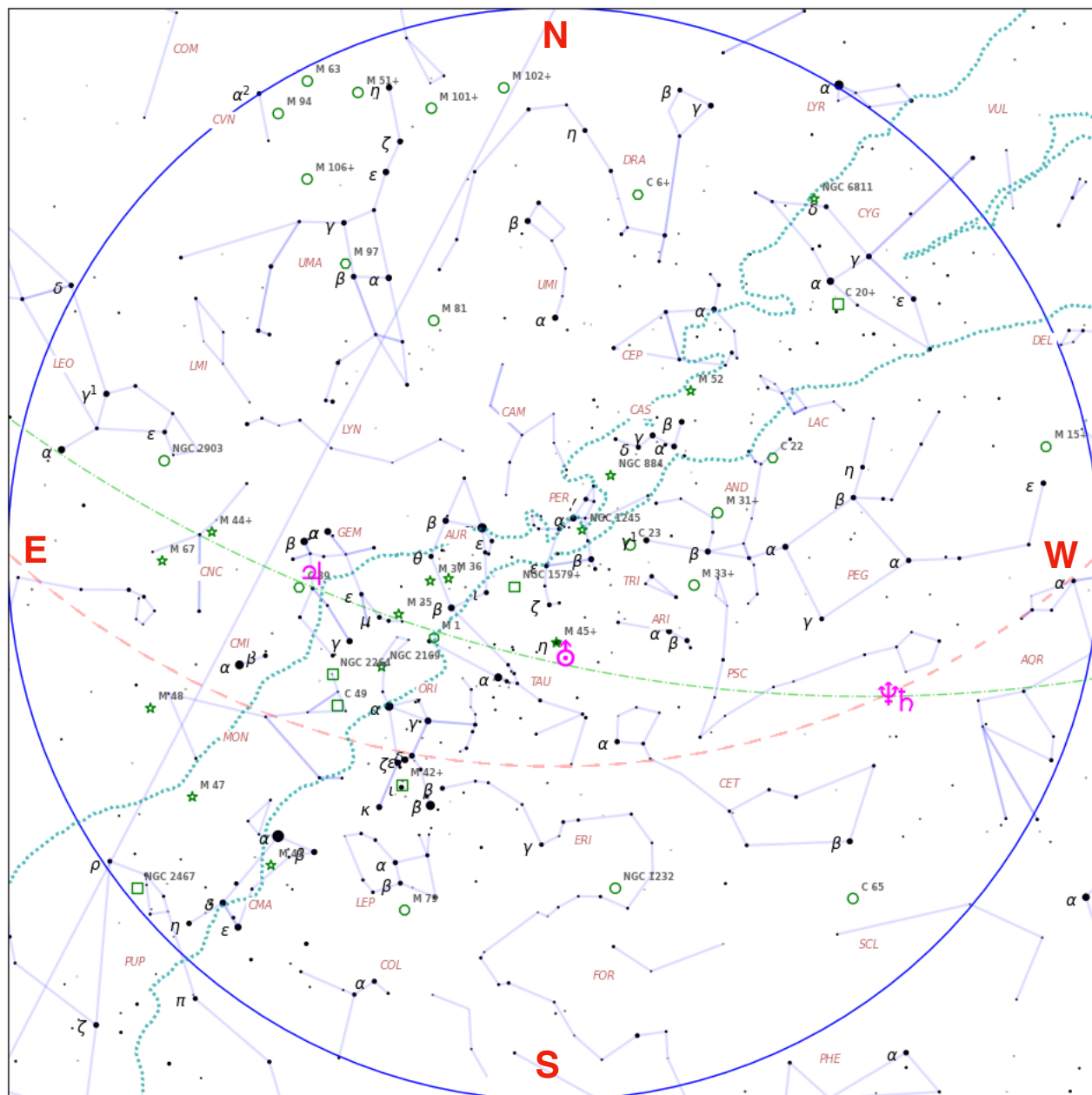


FEBRUARY 2026



The Northern Berkshire Astronomical Society

Meets the first Wednesday of every month, at the
North Adams Public Library at 6 PM.

74 Church St. North Adams MA

Winter Milky Way

The splendor of the Winter Milky Way constellations from Auriga overhead to Puppis in the SE have dozens of clusters and nebulae, with the bright “Winter Hexagon” stars to guide you!

Constellations

AND - Andromeda - *the Chained Maiden*
 ARI - Aries - *the Ram*
 AUR - Auriga - *the Charioteer*
 CAM - Camelopardalis - *the Giraffe*
 CAS - Cassiopeia - *the Queen of Ethiopia*
 CEP - Cepheus - *the King of Ethiopia*
 CET - Cetus - *the Whale*
 CMA - Canis Major - *the Greater Dog*
 CMI - Canis Minor - *the Lesser Dog*
 CNC - Cancer - *the Crab*
 COL - Columba - *the Dove*
 COM - Coma Berenices - *Berenices' Hair*
 CVN - Canes Venatici - *the Hunting Dogs*
 CYG - Cygnus - *the Swan*
 DRA - Draco - *the Dragon*
 ERI - Eridanus - *the River*
 FOR - Fornax - *the Chemical Furnace*
 GEM - Gemini - *the Twins*
 HYA - Hydra - *the Water Snake*
 LAC - Lacerta - *the Lizard*
 LEO - Leo - *the Lion*
 LEP - Lepus - *the Hare*
 LMI - Leo Minor - *the Lesser Lion*
 LYN - Lynx - *the Lynx*
 MON - Monoceros - *the Unicorn*
 ORI - Orion - *the Hunter*
 PEG - Pegasus - *the Winged Horse*
 PER - Perseus - *the Hero*
 PHE - Phoenix - *the Phoenix*
 PSC - Pisces - *the Fish*
 PUP - Puppis - *the Stern (of Argo)*
 PYX - Pyxis - *the Mariner's Compass*
 SCL - Sculptor - *the Sculptor's Workshop*
 SEX - Sextans - *the Sextant*
 TAU - Taurus - *the Bull*
 TRI - Triangulum - *the Triangle*
 UMA - Ursa Major - *the Great Bear*
 UMI - Ursa Minor - *the Lesser Bear*

How to Use the Chart

South is at the bottom, if you hold the chart “up” against the sky, facing South, then East will be to your left and West to the right. (Or if you hold the map upside-down and face North, East will be to the right, West to the left.)

On the chart, the orange dashed line shows the celestial Equator; the green dashed-dotted line the Ecliptic. The Milky Way is outlined with a blue dotted line.

Date	Time
Feb 1	9:00 PM (EST)
Feb 8	8:30 PM
Feb 15	8:00 PM
Feb 22	7:30 PM
Mar 1	7:00 PM

Because of the Earth's motion around the Sun, the time for this chart changes slowly over time, roughly 1/2 hour earlier every week:

Planets

Mercury, Venus, and Mars are all close to the Sun this month.

Jupiter in Gemini, up all night

Saturn is in Pisces, setting around 8:00 PM

Uranus is in Taurus, near the Pleiades - up all evening

Neptune is in Pisces, setting just after Saturn